

Old-fashioned Strawberry Shortcake

Makes 6 to 8 shortcakes

Biscuits:

2 cups all-purpose flour

4 teaspoons baking powder

1 teaspoon salt

¼ cup sugar

½ cup (1 stick) chilled unsalted butter, cut into bits

½ cup half-and-half, PLUS more for brushing on top

1 large egg, beaten

Topping:

3 cups hulled and sliced ripe strawberries

¼ cup sugar

1 cup heavy whipping cream

¼ teaspoon pure vanilla extract

Heat oven to 425 degrees.

Grease a large baking sheet and set aside.

Biscuits: In a large mixing bowl, mix together the flour, baking powder, salt and sugar. Add the butter and cut it in with a pastry cutter until the mixture is crumbly.

Add the half-and-half and egg, and stir just until the dry ingredients are moistened. Transfer the dough to a lightly floured work surface and knead 3 to 4 times. Roll out the dough ½-inch-thick, cut out rounds with a 2½-inch biscuit cutter, and arrange on the prepared baking sheet. Roll the scraps together and cut out more rounds. Brush the tops lightly with half-and-half and bake in the upper third of the oven until golden brown, 12-15 minutes.

Topping: While the biscuits bake, make the topping by tossing the strawberries and sugar together in a medium-size mixing bowl. In another medium-size mixing bowl, beat together the cream and vanilla with an electric mixer until thick but still soft.

Split the hot biscuits in half, spoon equal amounts of strawberries over the bottom halves, spoon the whipped cream over the strawberries, cover with the biscuit tops at an angle. Serve immediately.

— Adapted from "Biscuit Bliss" by James Villas